

A guide from Scribe

The Digital Transformation Survival Guide

“Transformation” is every CIO’s favorite buzzword. It’s in every board deck, every budget request, and every town hall. But ask what it actually means and you’ll get a different answer from every executive.

When most people say “transformation” today, they mean AI or automation. But here’s what’s actually happening: in half of enterprise transformation conversations, the current priority is system migration — legacy upgrades, M&A integrations, platform swaps. Everyone wants to say they’re doing AI to get ahead. Most are still catching up to the present.

This guide breaks down what transformation actually looks like — and what it takes to get it right. Here’s what’s inside.

01 The 5 types of transformation (and where more orgs start)

02 Why you can’t transform what you don’t understand

03 AI rollouts that enterprises are betting on right now

04 Automations that deliver results when given enough context

5 types of transformation.

Most orgs start with the wrong one.

Transformation isn't one thing. It's 5 distinct types of work.

1 **Systems modernization**

Consolidate and upgrade your tech stack. Most enterprises are currently here, migrating off legacy platforms before they can do anything else.

2 **Organizational readiness**

Get your team fluent in new ways of working with training. If people don't understand what AI can do or how to judge its output, new tools won't stick.

3 **Workflow optimization**

Improve how teams do the work itself. Map how work actually happens, find where it breaks down or has friction, and redesign the handoffs. When you can see the real work, you can know exactly where to optimize.

4 **AI augmentation**

Generate the right information for employees at the right moment so they can work more effectively. (For example, AI creates a summary of a customer's key issues before a support call.) But AI augmentation only works if it understands what information matters most at each step of work.

5 **Automation**

Reduce repetitive work by using AI to handle some tasks. Most organizations start here, but it's the wrong starting point. Automation only works after processes are mapped and context is reliable.

All five of these require the same foundation — and most orgs don't have it. That foundation is organizational context.

You can't transform what you don't understand.

Right now, research from MIT is showing that 95% of AI pilots fail to deliver ROI. This current trend informs Gartner's prediction that more than 40% of agentic AI projects will be canceled by 2027 due to unclear business outcomes.

The small fraction that do succeed share a common trait: they're deeply integrated into real workflows, not bolted on top of them. The reality is that thousands of tasks, decisions, handoffs, and exceptions are happening across the organization every day. Without context — about workflows, decision logic, constraints, dependencies, and outcomes — AI can only automate fragments.

Before you modernize systems, optimize workflows, or deploy AI, the critical first step is to understand how work actually gets done — not just the happy path in static documentation, but the real workflows, with their exceptions and edge cases. Most companies haven't started collecting the context needed to transform.

95%

of AI pilots fail to deliver ROI, according to research from MIT.

40%+

of agentic AI projects will be canceled by 2027, Gartner predicts.

The Context Maturity Framework.

To help organizations benchmark where they are and figure out what to do next, we built a Context Maturity Framework — a scale from L0 to L4.

L0

Invisible work

When you're here, AI is limited to generic copilots: drafting, summarizing, search.

L1

Static documentation

When you're here, AI works sometimes for answering questions about policy and "happy path."

L2

Observable workflows

When you're here, AI can recommend improvements, automations, opportunities to standardize workflows, and help employees work more with higher accuracy.

L3

Governed workflows

When you're here, agents can execute multi-step workflows reliably within defined boundaries.

L4

Continuously improving workflows

When you're here, AI doesn't just help people do tasks; agents operate with high autonomy in well-instrumented domains, with strong auditability.

Benchmark your org

You can take our free assessment to benchmark yourself and get next steps to move up the curve.

Take the assessment

AI rollouts worth betting on right now.

With the right context in place, AI can be rolled out and actually drive impact. Here's where teams are most commonly finding their first AI wins. These are the 6 use cases we see teams actively pursuing right now. Across all of these rollouts, AI won't work if it's starved for context.

1. Powering copilots for internal knowledge

Teams are feeding docs into copilots or custom LLMs so employees can ask process questions in natural language. This gives every employee access to the same knowledge — but only if your documentation is accurate and structured enough for an AI agent to act on it.

2. Self-documenting workflows

Enterprises use AI to generate documentation from the work itself, instead of asking people to write it manually. This saves a huge amount of time for teams, and is a prerequisite for #1.

3. Process discovery and efficiency recommendations

Many companies are using AI to surface undocumented processes, identify workflow variants, and recommend improvements without anyone having to ask.

4. Building custom AI agents for specific workflows

Teams build bots around specific domains (think: SAP support, back-office operations, internal IT) that answer questions using only approved company materials.

5. Summarization in business applications

Salesforce, ServiceNow, RingCentral, and dozens of other platforms are embedding AI to summarize context, surface next steps, and pre-populate fields.

6. Building their own agents

Some teams launch environments where non-technical employees can build AI agents within controlled boundaries. This lets employees add their own context, but only at an individual level — not org-wide.

Identify more AI opportunities

Automations that deliver on day one.

AI changes how people work, but automation frees up time for teams to focus on high impact work versus repeatable tasks. Here's where teams are starting. Teams often automate the most visible use cases first, while missing the highest-value ones. Enterprises have seen success with the obvious automations, but the smaller, org-specific opportunities often deliver more ROI. The most common automations are:

Report generation

Teams replacing hours of weekly data pulling with automated reports sent straight to group messages or leadership.

Data entry and exception handling

Reducing manual intervention on high-volume, repetitive transactions.

CRM and sales workflows

Automating opportunity creation, quote generation, and account monitoring so reps spend time selling, not updating records.

Invoice and payment processing

Turning multi-step approval and reconciliation workflows into automated end-to-end processes.

Cross-system data transfer

Eliminating the copy-paste work of moving data between platforms that don't talk to each other.

Sales and customer follow-up

Triggering outreach automatically based on customer actions instead of relying on manual reminders.

[Find more automation ideas](#)

Every use case above has one thing in common — it depends on context most organizations don't have yet.

Your fast track to transformation.

Context is the bridge from AI experimentation to actual organizational transformation. To build that context, you need to do three things — and do them continuously:

1 Discovering how work actually gets done

2 Documenting and visualizing it in a format that's usable by both humans and agents

3 Prioritizing and planning automation and AI opportunities in the right order

Scribe Optimize builds the context layer your AI needs — continuously capturing how work actually gets done across your entire organization.



Continuously see how work actually gets done

- Automatically discover workflows with minimal setup
- Get instant, continuous visibility across teams and tools
- Create documentation for any workflow instantly



Understand how work happens and where to improve it

- Ask an AI agent to explain any workflow instantly
- Generate process maps for any workflow with actual data
- Map every step and handoff automatically
- See workflows ranked by potential impact
- Spot bottlenecks, top issues, and the tasks that slow your team down



Turn insight into impact

- Get ROI-backed recommendations for improvement
- Build custom projects that solve your org's actual issues, powered by AI
- Get step-by-step detail to bring any improvement to life



[Request a demo](#)